

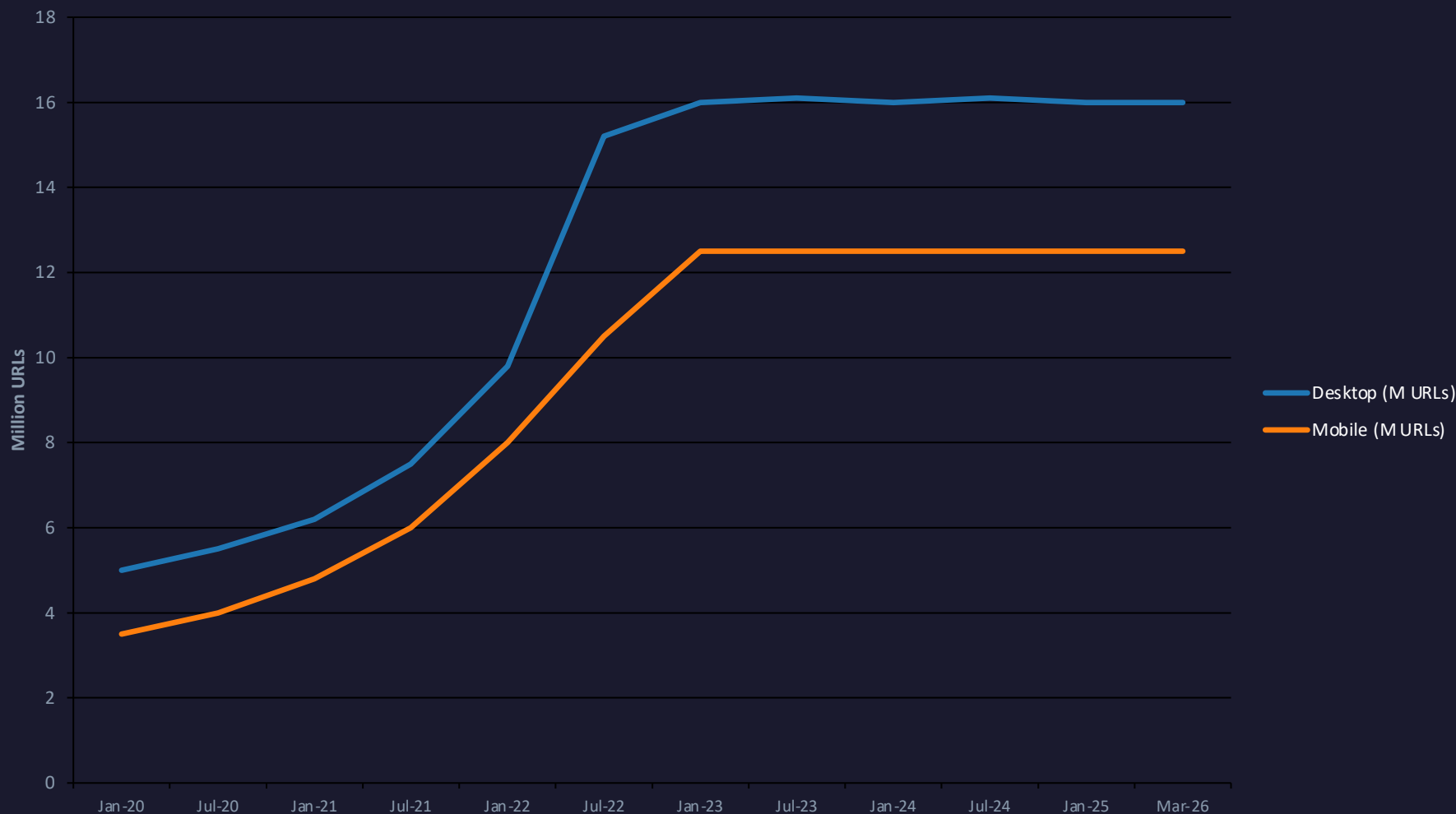
State of the Web 2020–2025

HTTP Archive Trends in Page Weight, Protocols & Security

Data Source	HTTP Archive — httparchive.org
Period	January 2020 – March 2026
Scope	Desktop & Mobile · Millions of URLs per crawl

Crawl Sample Size Tripled

From ~5M to 16M Desktop URLs Since 2020



16M

Desktop URLs

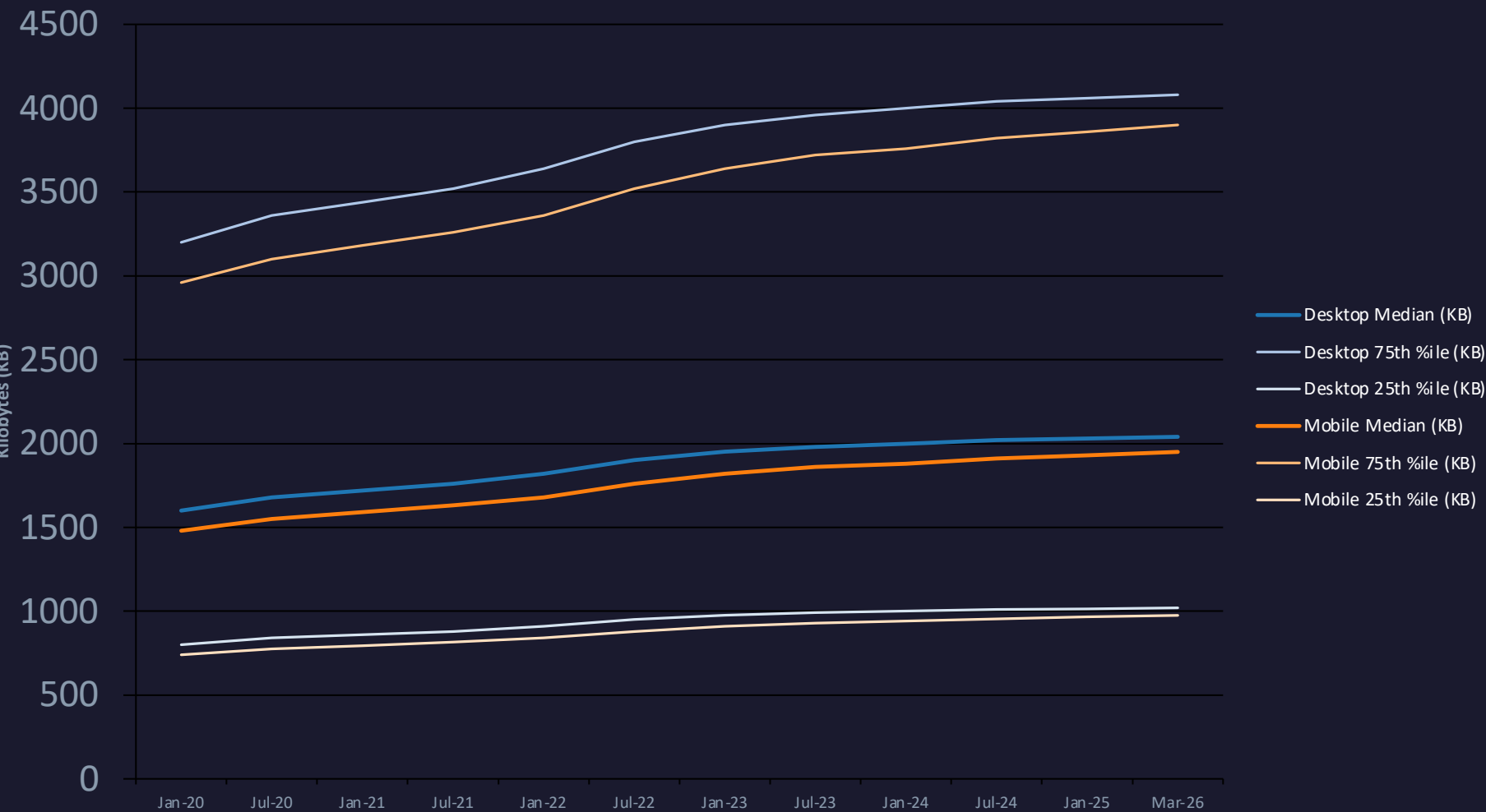
12.5M

Mobile URLs

Sharp jump mid-2022 reflects expanded infrastructure investment by HTTP Archive.

Median Page Weight Climbs Steadily to ~2,000 KB on Desktop

Total kilobytes transferred (median, desktop vs mobile) with interquartile bands



2,000 KB

Desktop Median (2026)

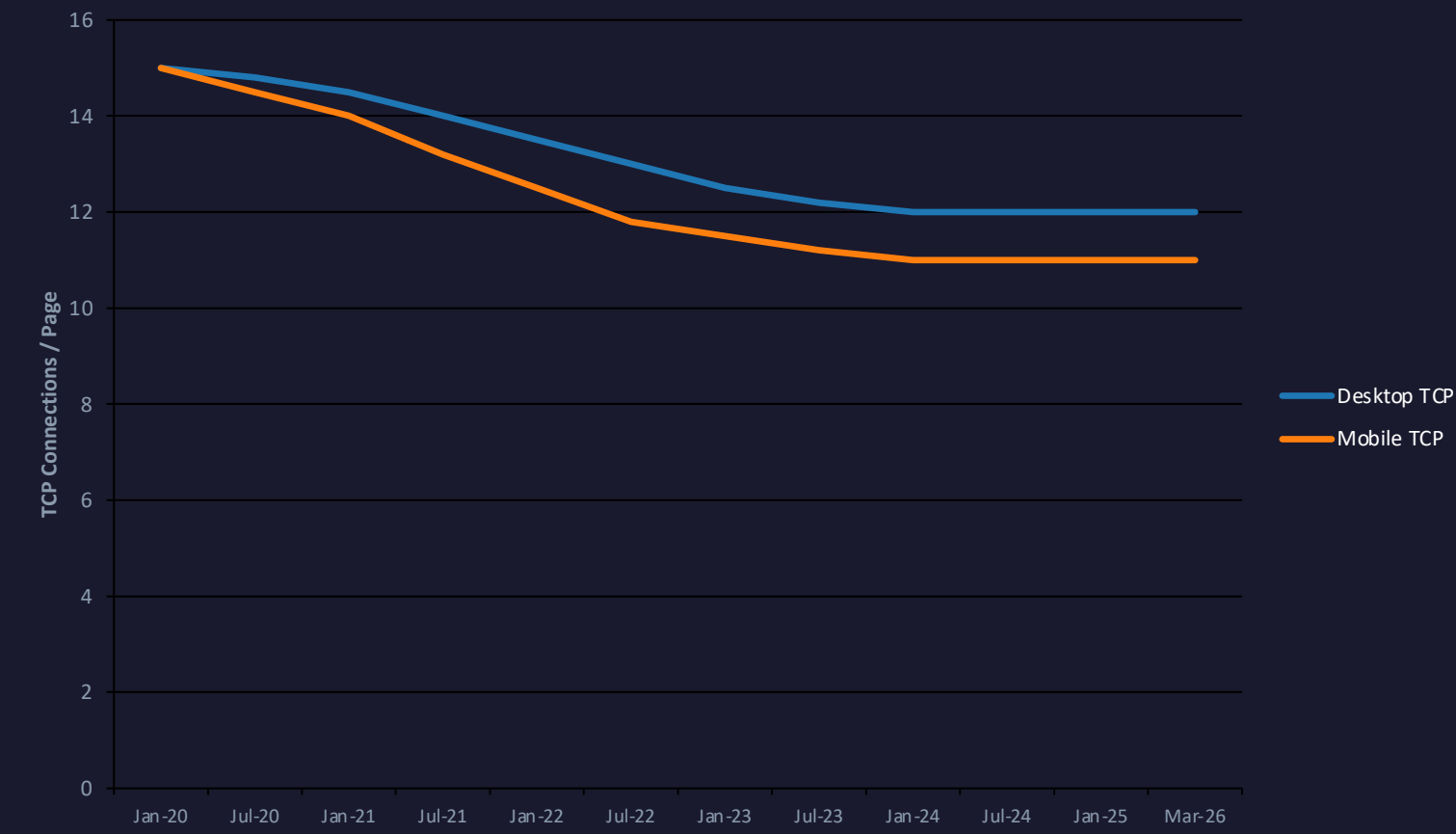
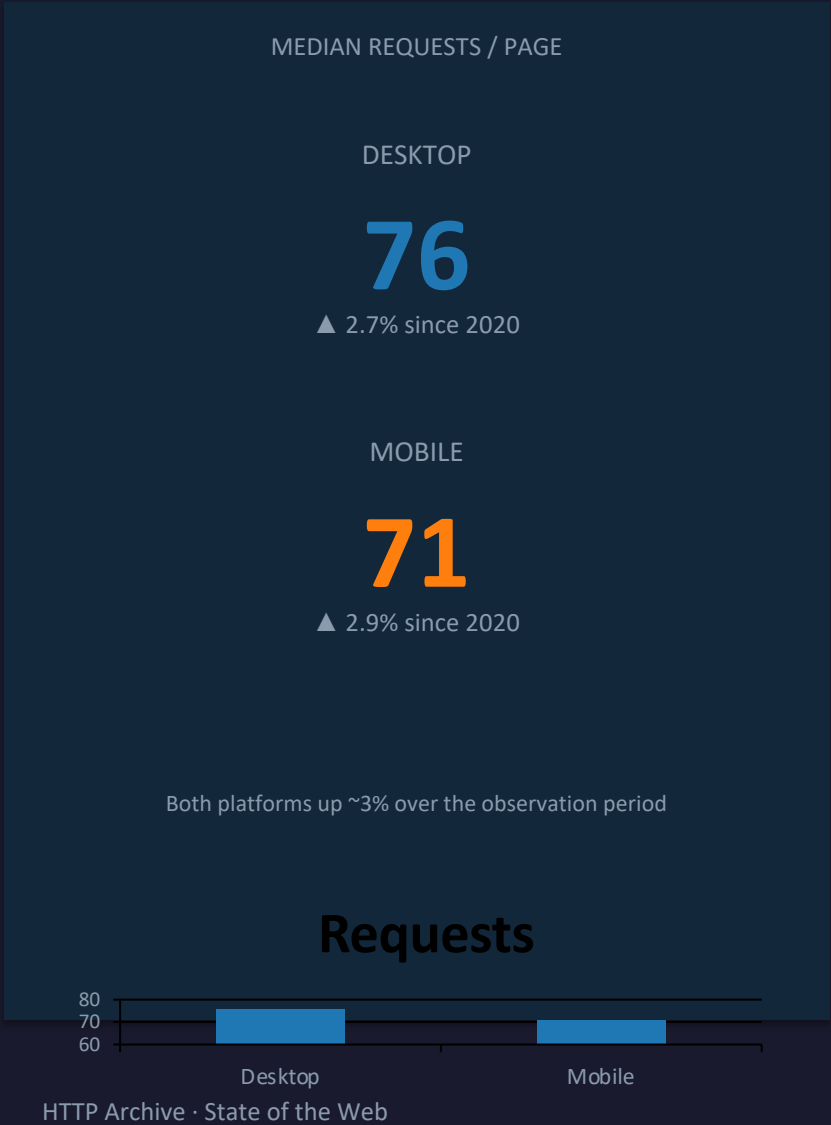
+25%

vs. ~1,600 KB in Jan 2020

75th pct. exceeds 4,000 KB — long tail of heavy pages.

76 Requests per Desktop Page While TCP Connections Drop to 12

Split view: request counts rising vs. TCP connections declining via HTTP/2 & HTTP/3 multiplexing



▼ 20% fewer TCP connections despite ▼ 3% more requests — multiplexing at work.

HTTPS Requests Reach 99%: Encryption Is Now the Default

Near-total adoption across both desktop and mobile platforms

99%+

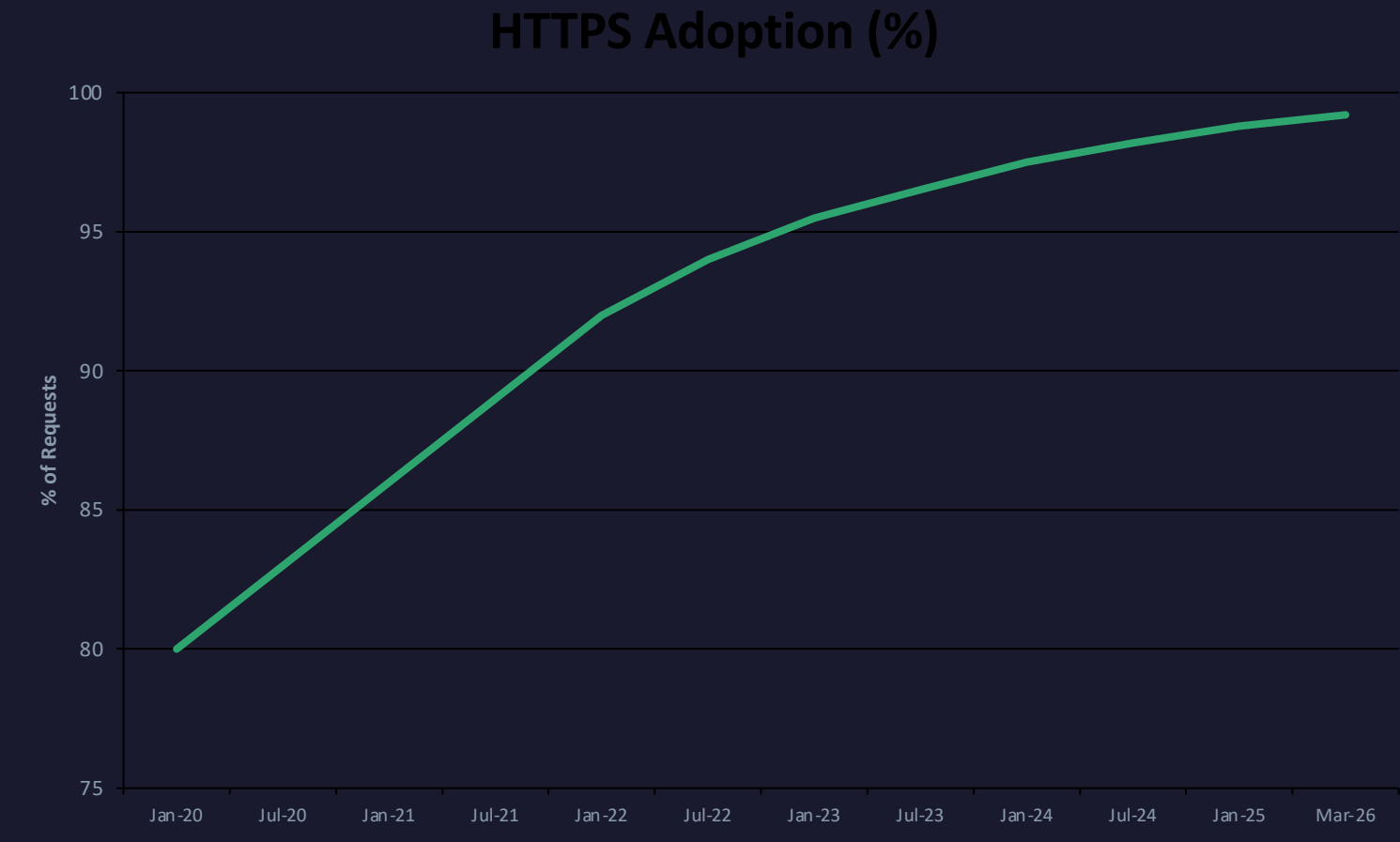
HTTPS Requests

Desktop	99.2%
Mobile	99.1%

+19–20 pp since 2020

↑ from ~80% in Jan 2020

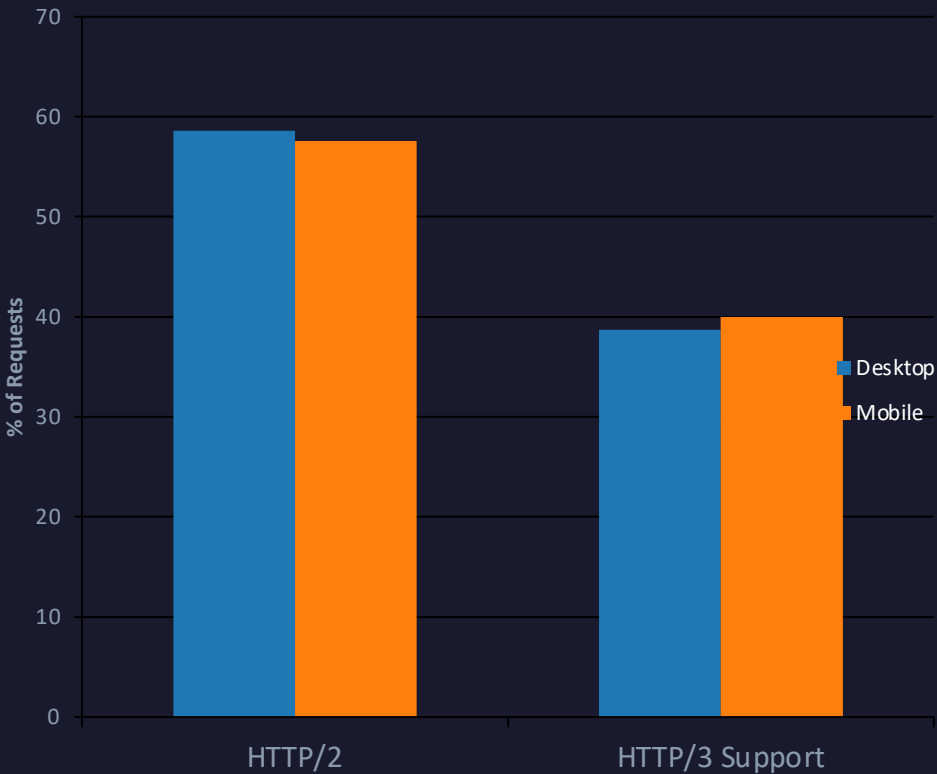
Plaintext HTTP is effectively extinct on the modern web.



▲ 80% → 99.2% | HTTPS went from minority to universal standard in 6 years

HTTP/2 Holds at ~58% While HTTP/3 Support Surges to 40%

Protocol adoption snapshot and HTTP/3's rapid growth trajectory



HTTP/2 Desktop

58.6%

Flat / +1–3% recent

HTTP/2 Mobile

57.6%

Flat / +1–3% recent

HTTP/3 Desktop

38.7%

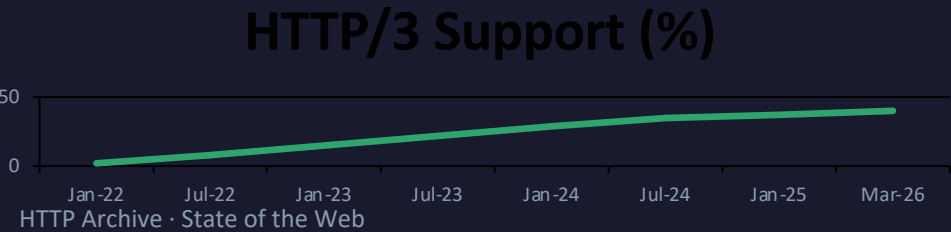
▲ 38,600% from near-zero

HTTP/3 Mobile

40.0%

▲ 5,614% from near-zero

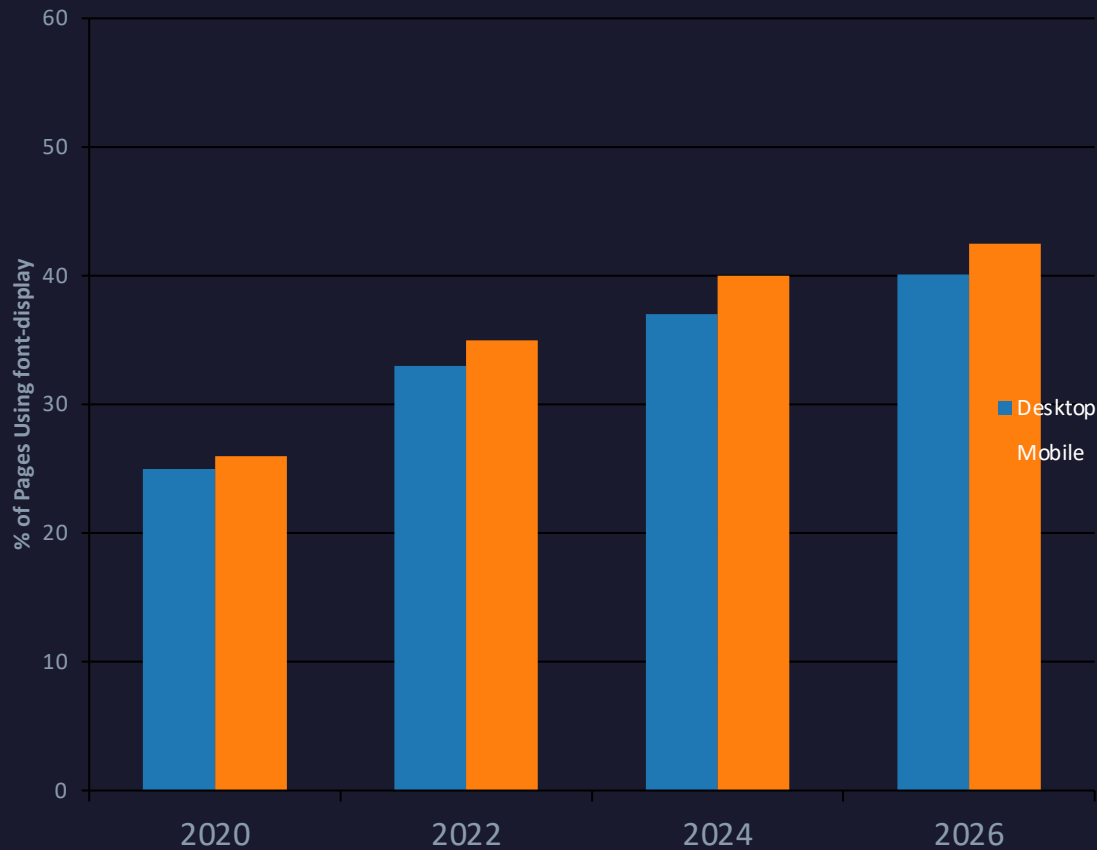
HTTP/3 Support Growth



Note: HTTP Archive measures HTTP/3 support, not actual usage — fresh Chrome instances default to HTTP/2 before discovering HTTP/3 via Alt-Svc headers.

Font-Display Usage Reaches 42% on Mobile, Up 61% Since 2020

CSS font-display property adoption — avoids Flash of Invisible Text (FOIT)



Desktop

40.1%

▲ 14.9% since 2020

Mobile

42.5%

▲ 61.0% since 2020

Flash of Invisible Text (FOIT) occurs when browsers hide text while custom fonts load. The `font-display: swap` or `optional` values tell the browser to show a fallback font first — improving perceived performance.

>57% of pages still risk FOIT. Adoption has room to grow.

Key Takeaways

Bigger Pages · Smarter Protocols · Stronger Security

1

Page weight keeps climbing — but at a moderate pace

Median desktop pages now transfer ~2,000 KB — ~25% heavier than 2020. This trend is driven by richer media, JavaScript bundles, and third-party embeds.

2

HTTPS is the new baseline

At 99%+ of requests, unencrypted HTTP is essentially extinct. Security is no longer a differentiator — it is the default expectation.

3

HTTP/3 is the fastest-growing protocol metric

From near-zero to ~40% support in under four years. HTTP/3 is rapidly becoming mainstream, enabled by QUIC and server-push improvements.

4

Fewer TCP connections despite more requests

Multiplexing in HTTP/2 and HTTP/3 has cut median connections per page by 15–27%, improving network efficiency and reducing handshake overhead.

5

Font-display still underused

At ~40–42% adoption, more than half of pages still risk Flash of Invisible Text. Auditing font loading is a high-ROI front-end optimization.

Benchmark your own sites against these baselines · httparchive.org/reports/state-of-the-web